refuting such ideas out of a sense of politeness will be misplaced. Stating things on the record are of utmost importance in negotiating with China. This must be done at all times.

China is a master at manipulating time. If the interlocutor is reluctant to bend to the Chinese demands, they will start by referring to the long history of China and their capacity to display patience. This is intended to signal to the opposite interlocutor that China is not under any pressure of time, and allows them to gauge if this is not the case with the Indian side.

If there is any hint that the Indian interlocutor is under pressure of time, the Chinese will try to trap the negotiator against the deadline in order to force a decision that is favourable to China. China uses a variety of tactics in such cases. It may slow down the negotiations, or even allow them to break down. It may humiliate the opposite interlocutor by suggesting that she or he does not have the authority to negotiate or it may level the charge of 'backtracking'. These tactics can play with the interlocutor's mental state at a particularly stressful time in the negotiating process. It is, therefore, vital that the Indian side does not allow itself to be constrained by the factor of time in any major negotiation with China.

On some occasions, if the subject is of importance to the Chinese side or if they think that a resolution of the issue is in line with their interests, and if the formal talks are not making the desired headway, the Chinese will seek an informal discussion. Usually with other countries, such informal meetings are one-to-one and off the record, but with the Chinese it is more likely that the interlocutor will bring an associate as well as the ubiquitous interpreter. It is advisable for the Indian side to similarly have a note-taker and an interpreter. Somebody who had long experience in dealing with the Chinese